NSE Trade Desk: your guide

Daily routine, placing trades in ICICI Direct, the exit guardian, going live, and where every setting lives. Version of 21 Oct 2026 (links added). Keep this with you; the local project folder is no longer needed.

> Research tool only. Not investment advice and not a SEBI-registered adviser. No returns are guaranteed. Options can lose money quickly. Start with 1 lot and only trade what you can afford to lose.

1. What you have and where it lives

Piece	Where	What it does
Trade Desk app	https://rishiraj210984.github.io/nse-engine/ (home-screen icon on your phone)	Plan, decisions (TRADE / SKIP), live prices, ICICI order tickets, your trades, results
Engine + learning	https://github.com/RishiRaj210984/nse-engine	Runs 00:07, 07:13, 16:17 IST and every 10 min in market hours; re-learns each evening
Exit guardian	Oracle Cloud server, Mumbai, IP 144.24.100.32, user ubuntu	Reads your ICICI positions, alerts or exits by the rules; enters the plan trade on command
ICICI Breeze API	https://api.icicidirect.com/apiuser/home (app 'guardian')	ICICI's official API. Registered with the server's static IP
Alerts and commands	ntfy app on your phone + Trade Desk Live tab	Alerts topic: guardian to you. Command topic + PIN: you to guardian
Server key file	Your safe place (not Drive, email or GitHub). A copy is in Oracle Cloud Shell	Lets you log in to the server

All links (tap to open)

Every address you need, written out. Open them in **Chrome** (or Safari on iPhone). No searching needed.

What	Link
Trade Desk app (add to home screen)	https://rishiraj210984.github.io/nse-engine/
This guide (online copy)	https://rishiraj210984.github.io/nse-engine/USER_GUIDE.pdf
ICICI Breeze portal (your API app, keys, static IP)	https://api.icicidirect.com/apiuser/home
ICICI daily login for the guardian	Use the app: Live tab > Guardian > **1. Log in to ICICI** (it builds https://api.icicidirect.com/apiuser/login?api_key=... for you)
ICICI Direct website login	https://secure.icicidirect.com/IDirectTrading/Customer/login.aspx
ICICI Direct app (Android)	https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.icicidirect.idirectsuper
ICICI Direct app (iPhone)	https://apps.apple.com/in/app/icici-direct-stocks-f-o-mf-ipo/id1642076943
ntfy alerts app (Android)	https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=io.heckel.ntfy
ntfy alerts app (iPhone)	https://apps.apple.com/us/app/ntfy/id1625396347
Oracle Cloud console (server, Cloud Shell)	https://cloud.oracle.com/
Your server list (Mumbai)	https://cloud.oracle.com/compute/instances?region=ap-mumbai-1

What	Link
GitHub project (code and history)	https://github.com/RishiRaj210984/nse-engine
Engine runs (see or start a run)	https://github.com/RishiRaj210984/nse-engine/actions/workflows/daily-engine.yml
GitHub tokens (for on-time runs)	https://github.com/settings/personal-access-tokens
NSE trading holidays	https://www.nseindia.com/resources/exchange-communication-holidays

2. Daily routine (trading days)

Time (IST)	Where	Do this
After 00:07 (optional)	Trade Desk > Home	Preview of tomorrow. Don't act on it.
Before 09:20	Trade Desk > Live > Guardian	1. Log in to ICICI (opens api.icicidirect.com in Chrome). Copy the number after apisession= from the address bar (the page shows '405', that is normal). 2. Paste it. 3. Send login code. Wait for the alert 'Guardian: logged in'.
07:20 to 09:00	Trade Desk > Home	Read the FINAL plan: Quick view, global markets, Nifty and BankNifty boxes. Only boxes marked TRADE are trades.
09:15 to 10:15	-	Wait. The first hour is the noisiest.
10:15 to 11:30	ICICI app, or Guardian button	If a box says TRADE and the entry condition holds: place it (section 3) or tap 'Enter ... via guardian'.
During the day	ntfy alerts	Nothing to do. Alerts say BOOK PROFIT / EXIT NOW. In paper mode they say what it would do.
After 16:17	Trade Desk > Home	Check the profit and loss bar for the day.

If the app says a run is late (red notice), tap the refresh button after a few minutes. NSE holidays show 'Market closed'.

3. Placing a condor by hand in ICICI Direct (1 lot)

Open the box marked TRADE on Home and expand **ICICI Direct order ticket**. It lists the 4 legs, prices and the GTT values.

Step	In the ICICI Direct app
1. Basket	Create a basket. From the option chain (right expiry) add the 4 legs, BUY legs first. Quantity = lot size (Nifty 65, BankNifty 30). Product: Options (NOT Options Plus, which closes at 3:15 PM). Order type: Limit at the ticket price. Check the margin shown.
2. Enter	At 10:15, if the index is between the two SELL strikes, execute the basket. Check all 4 legs filled in Positions.
3. Protect	Place one GTT OCO BUY on each SOLD leg with the ticket's target and stop. Set each limit Rs 1 to 3 above its trigger. If your fills differ: target = 45% of your sell price; stop = your sell price + your total credit.
4. Record	Trade Desk > Live > 'I took today's ... Iron Condor' (or add it by hand with your fills).
5. Close	When both sold legs are bought back (GTT), sell the 2 bought legs or let them expire if almost worthless. If one stop fires, close the rest the same day. If you close a leg yourself, cancel its GTT.

4. The exit guardian

Runs on your Oracle server all day. **Paper mode** (now): alerts only, places no orders. **Live mode**: places the plan trade when you tap Enter, and exits whole trades by the rules. It never opens a trade by itself and never trades more than you hold.

Rule	Condors / sold options	Bought options
Book profit	55% of the credit is in hand	+60% (book at least half)
Stop	Loss equals the credit	-30%
Protect gains	-	Stop moves to cost after +20%; trails 25% below the peak after +40%
Time	Hold to expiry	Exit by 15:15

Button (Trade Desk > Live > Guardian)	What happens
1 / 2 / 3 Log in and send code	Gives the guardian today's ICICI session (needed every trading day, ICICI rule)
Enter NIFTY / BANKNIFTY via guardian	Only if today's plan says TRADE, 10:10 to 11:30, index inside the short strikes. BUY legs first, limit orders, checks each fill
Status	Alert listing every open trade with P&L and what the rules say
Exit all	Closes every option position now (live) or says what it would close (paper)
Pause / Resume	Stops / restarts all automatic entries and exits

If anything fails (rejected order, part fill, expired login) you get an urgent alert. Then act by hand in ICICI.

5. Going live: checklist and exact steps

Only when all of these are true:

Check	Done?
At least 3 to 5 paper days where the alerts matched what you would want	
Guardian P&L matched ICICI's Positions screen within a few rupees	
ICICI account has enough margin for 1 lot (check the basket margin; usually tens of thousands of rupees)	
You know how to Pause, and how to exit by hand in ICICI	

Switch to live (on the server, see section 7 for how to connect):

```
nano ~/nse-engine/guardian.env # change MODE=paper to MODE=live, keep MAX_LOTS=1
# save: F3 then Enter, exit: Ctrl+X
sudo sed -i 's#guardian.py run$#guardian.py run --live#' /etc/systemd/system/guardian.service
sudo systemctl daemon-reload && sudo systemctl restart guardian
```

Your phone gets 'Guardian started · Mode: LIVE'. Both switches are needed (MODE=live and --live); either alone keeps it in paper mode.

Back to paper at any time:

```
nano ~/nse-engine/guardian.env # MODE=paper
sudo sed -i 's#guardian.py run --live#guardian.py run#' /etc/systemd/system/guardian.service
sudo systemctl daemon-reload && sudo systemctl restart guardian
```

Emergency: tap Pause in the app (or Exit all), then close positions in ICICI by hand if needed.

6. Where every setting lives

On the server: file `~/nse-engine/guardian.env` (only there; never shared, never in GitHub).

Setting	Meaning
BREEZE_API_KEY, BREEZE_API_SECRET	From the Breeze portal (your app 'guardian')
BREEZE_SESSION_TOKEN	Today's login code. Normally sent from the app each morning; no need to edit
MODE	paper (alerts only) or live (may place and exit orders; also needs --live)
NTFY_TOPIC	Alerts to your phone (subscribe to it in the ntfy app)
NTFY_CMD_TOPIC, GUARDIAN_PIN	Commands from your phone. Keep both private; the PIN must not be your username or birth date
MAX_LOTS	Most lots one Enter may place (keep 1 at first)
MAX_DAILY_ORDERS, POLL_SECONDS, TRAIL_PCT	Safety cap (12), check interval (20 s), trailing gap for bought options (25%)
GITHUB_TOKEN	Starts the engine runs on time from the server (section 8)

On your phone: Trade Desk > Live > Guardian settings (command topic, PIN, Breeze API key) and Live prices relay (optional). Capital and risk % for share sizing: Stocks tab. These stay only on that phone.

Lot sizes and expiry days follow NSE circulars (Nifty 65, BankNifty 30 in 2026). If NSE changes them, ask Claude to update backend/config.py in the repo.

7. Server: connect and common commands

Open https://cloud.oracle.com/ > sign in > the >_ Cloud Shell icon in the top bar. Prompt `rishirajme@cloudshell` = Cloud Shell; connect to the server with:

```
ssh -i ~/ssh-key-*.key ubuntu@144.24.100.32
```

You are on the server when the prompt shows `ubuntu@guardian`. Then:

Task	Command
Is the guardian running?	`sudo systemctl status guardian --no-pager | head -5`
Last 30 guardian lines	`journalctl -u guardian -n 30 --no-pager`
Restart it	`sudo systemctl restart guardian`
Stop it	`sudo systemctl stop guardian`
Get latest code	`cd ~/nse-engine && git pull && sudo systemctl restart guardian`
Read-only check	`cd ~/nse-engine && .venv/bin/python backend/guardian.py check`
Edit settings	`nano ~/nse-engine/guardian.env` (save F3 + Enter, exit Ctrl+X)
On-time run log	`tail -5 ~/nse-engine/trigger.log`

In the browser, Ctrl+O opens a file window: use F3 in nano instead. Cloud Shell disconnects after a while; just run the ssh line again.

8. One-time: make the morning runs on time

GitHub's own schedule ran the 07:13 plan at 12:03 on 21 Oct. The server now starts each run on the minute. Needs one GitHub token (5 minutes):

Step	Do
1	Open https://github.com/settings/personal-access-tokens/new (or github.com > your photo > Settings > Developer settings > Personal access tokens > Fine-grained tokens > Generate new token)
2	Name: engine-trigger. Expiration: 1 year. Repository access: Only select repositories > nse-engine. Permissions > Repository permissions > Actions: Read and write. Generate, copy it (shown once).
3	On the server: `nano ~/nse-engine/guardian.env`, add a line `GITHUB_TOKEN=` followed by the token. Save (F3, Enter), exit (Ctrl+X).
4	On the server: `cd ~/nse-engine && git pull && bash server/install-cron.sh`. It ends with 'publish -> HTTP 204 ok'.

Renew the token before it expires (GitHub emails a reminder). Never paste it into a chat.

9. Troubleshooting

You see	Do this
App shows an old time / red 'run is late'	Wait a few minutes and refresh. Still late: open Engine runs > Run workflow > task premarket (morning) or postclose (evening). Check section 8 is done.
'Couldn't download the latest plan'	Phone offline, or office Wi-Fi blocking github.io. Use mobile data.
App looks old after an update	Close it fully and reopen; if still old, remove the home-screen icon and add it again from https://rishiraj210984.github.io/nse-engine/ in Chrome.
'Guardian: not logged in' / 'cannot read positions'	Send today's login code again (section 2).
'405 Not Allowed' after ICICI login	Normal. Copy the number after apisession= from the address bar.
No alerts at all	ntfy app: subscribed to the exact alerts topic (server ntfy.sh)? On the server: guardian running? (section 7)
'EXIT FAILED' / 'CHECK ICICI NOW'	Open ICICI, see what filled, close or adjust by hand. Then Pause the guardian if unsure.
Box says NO TRADE	Nothing to place today. Not trading is a valid decision.

10. Safety rules and getting help

• Never share your ICICI password, Breeze API key or secret, PIN, session codes, GitHub token or the server key file, with anyone including Claude.

• Keep personal trading off work devices and work networks.

• Only boxes marked TRADE. Start with 1 lot. Respect the worst cases shown in each box.

• Back-tested numbers are estimates from rebuilt option prices, not broker fills. Live results decide.

• To change anything later: start a new Claude session and say: Clone https://github.com/RishiRaj210984/nse-engine and continue. Paste error messages (never keys) and Claude can fix them.